

4. Go to **Format > Conditional Formatting...**

The Conditional Formatting box will appear.

5. In this box, change Condition 1 to 'Formula Is'.

6. Next, you can type ' $=\$B2=0$ ' without the quotation marks. This is saying

that if the cell in this row that resides on the B column is equal to zero, then the conditional formatting will be applied.

7. Click 'Format'... to specify the format applied when the condition is true. The format can include font, cell colour, borders, and more. In this example, we set the formatting to not format the cell at all.

8. Click 'Add >>' to add another row in the Conditional Formatting box.

9. Repeat steps 5 through 7 twice. Specify different formatting options and use the following formulas: ' $=\$B2<0$ ' and ' $=\$B2>0$ '. When you're done, your Conditional Formatting box should look like the sample alongside.

10. When you are done, click OK and your Excel file should look like the example on the next page.



Bring up the Conditional Formatting box



Keep adding conditions till you're done

The possibilities are almost endless with conditional formatting. Instead of using 'Formula Is', you can use 'Cell Value Is'. From there, you can specify what the cell value should be equal to, should not be equal to, should be between etc. Sadly, you are limited to only three possible conditions on any given cell. If you are going to be using alpha characters instead of numeric characters, the alpha characters must reside within quotation marks in your formula. For example: $=\$B2='Ram'$.